

Bangladesh's Sex Workers: A Quiz

Topic: Bangladesh's Sex Workers | Difficulty: Medium | Questions: 5 | Model: gemini-2.5-flash

1. What is the general legal status of adult sex work within designated brothels in Bangladesh?

- A. It is completely illegal and criminalized nationwide.
- B. It is legal for adult women within registered brothels, but illegal outside them. (correct)**
- C. It is decriminalized but not fully legalized or regulated.
- D. It is fully legal and regulated as a profession across the country.

Explanation: While sex work outside designated areas and related activities like pimping or child prostitution are illegal, adult sex work within registered brothels has a complex legal status, often tolerated or implicitly legal for adult women, affirmed by some court rulings.

2. Despite legal prohibitions, what is a significant challenge regarding the age of entry into sex work in Bangladesh?

- A. Most sex workers voluntarily enter the profession after the age of 25.
- B. A high prevalence of child sex workers, often trafficked or sold into the trade, remains a critical issue. (correct)**
- C. The government provides extensive rehabilitation programs for underage individuals entering sex work.
- D. There are no known cases of underage sex workers in registered brothels due to strict enforcement.

Explanation: Child sex work, often linked to trafficking, poverty, and debt bondage, remains a severe and persistent problem in Bangladesh, despite being illegal.

3. How are sex workers generally perceived and treated within broader Bangladeshi society?

- A. They are fully integrated and respected members of their communities.
- B. They face significant social stigma, discrimination, and ostracization. (correct)**
- C. They are seen primarily as victims and receive widespread public sympathy and support.
- D. Their profession is considered a normal and accepted form of employment.

Explanation: Sex workers in Bangladesh face immense social stigma, discrimination, and are often ostracized from mainstream society, their families, and religious communities.

4. What is a primary health concern for sex workers in Bangladesh, often exacerbated by their working conditions and social status?

- A. High rates of cardiovascular disease due to sedentary lifestyles.
- B. Increased risk of sexually transmitted infections (STIs), including HIV, and limited access to healthcare. (correct)**
- C. Malnutrition due to lack of food availability in brothels.
- D. Respiratory illnesses from poor air quality in urban areas.

Explanation: Sex workers face a disproportionately high risk of STIs, including HIV, due to the nature of their work, often compounded by inconsistent condom use, limited access to healthcare, and social barriers to seeking treatment.

5. What is often cited as a major underlying factor driving women into sex work in Bangladesh?

- A. A desire for social rebellion and unconventional lifestyles.
- B. High levels of education leading to limited career options.
- C. Extreme poverty, lack of economic alternatives, and debt bondage. (correct)**
- D. Government-sponsored programs encouraging the profession.

Explanation: Poverty, economic hardship, lack of education, and debt bondage are frequently cited as primary reasons women and girls enter sex work in Bangladesh, often with little other choice.

Answer Key

1. **B** It is legal for adult women within registered brothels, but illegal outside them.
2. **B** A high prevalence of child sex workers, often trafficked or sold into the trade, remains a critical issue.
3. **B** They face significant social stigma, discrimination, and ostracization.
4. **B** Increased risk of sexually transmitted infections (STIs), including HIV, and limited access to healthcare.
5. **C** Extreme poverty, lack of economic alternatives, and debt bondage.